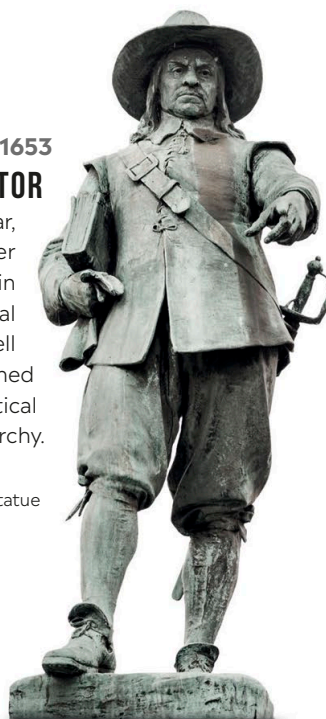


CROMWELL BECOMES LORD PROTECTOR

A leading Parliamentary commander in the English Civil War, Oliver Cromwell emerged as the dominant figure in Britain after the execution of Charles I. Having brutally crushed resistance in Ireland and Scotland, in 1653 he assumed almost dictatorial powers as Lord Protector of the Commonwealth. Cromwell aggressively promoted British interests abroad and maintained order at home, but he failed to create a durable republican political system. After his death in 1658 Britain soon returned to monarchy.

▷ Oliver Cromwell statue

1653



1650

1651 Polish forces defeat Ukrainian Cossack rebels at Berestechko

1654 Portuguese colonists take Brazilian sugar plantations from the Dutch

1650 Sultan bin Saif captures the port of Muscat, driving the Portuguese out of Oman

1652 French king Louis XIV enters Paris, ending the Fronde rebellion

1652 ANGLO-DUTCH TRADE WARS

By the 1650s, England and the Netherlands were commercial rivals, competing for maritime trade and colonial bases worldwide. In 1652, this rivalry turned into open warfare as Dutch and English naval squadrons battled in the North Sea and the Channel. The first Anglo-Dutch War culminated in an English victory off Scheveningen in 1653. Two more naval wars were fought before peace was made in 1674.

◁ The Battle of Scheveningen

